

Chetana Sabnis

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EDUCATION

Exp. 2027 **Ph.D. in Political Science, Yale University**

Dissertation: Intimacy Contract: States and Hierarchies of Familial Belonging

Committee: Elisabeth Jean Wood (co-chair), Joseph Fischel (co-chair), Dara Strolovitch, Egor Lazarev

Fields: Comparative Politics, Political Economy

2017 **M.A. in Social Sciences, University of Chicago**

2014 **Integrated M.A. in Development Studies, Indian Institute of Technology Madras**

RESEARCH

SUBMITTED AND UNDER REVIEW

Sabnis, Chetana. 2026. "Intimacy Contract: How States Define Family." Under review.

Sabnis, Chetana. 2026. "Beyond Pattern Matching: Using Large Language Models to Unlock Court Data." Under review.

Sabnis, Chetana. 2025. "How Indian Courts Determine Which Extramarital Relationships to Recognize." Under review.

WORKS IN PROGRESS

Sabnis, Chetana. 2026. "How American Courts Decide Who Counts as a Parent."

Sabnis, Chetana. 2022. "Investigating the Political Consciousness of Police Officials: A Case Study of Colonial British Police Officials, 1857–1947."

Sabnis, Chetana. 2022. "U.S. Courts' Decisions on 'Communists' in the McCarthy Era, 1948–67."

FELLOWSHIPS, GRANTS, AND AWARDS

2025–2026 MacMillan International Dissertation Research Fellowship, Yale University (\$6,000)

2025 Macmillan Center International Conference Travel Grant, Yale University (\$800)
Graduate Student Assembly Conference Travel Fellowship, Yale University (\$500)

2022 MacMillan Center Predissertation Research Grant, Yale University (\$4,100)
South Asian Studies Council Graduate Award, Yale University (\$3,500)

2016 Social Sciences Scholarship, University of Chicago (\$35,808)

2012 DAAD Student Exchange Scholarship, Hochschule Bremen, Germany (\$2,000)

CONFERENCES AND PRESENTATIONS

- 2025 American Political Science Association (APSA)
Law and Society Association (LSA)
Graduate Research on Contemporary South Asia Conference, Brown University
Gender, Human Rights and Security Conference, Columbia University
Comparative Politics Workshop, Yale University
Women's, Gender and Sexuality Studies Colloquium, Yale University
2024 Political Violence and its Legacies Workshop, Yale University
2022 Democracy, Violence, and Constitutional Order Workshop, Yale University

TEACHING AND RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- 2026 Teaching Fellow, *Politics of The Wire* (Prof. Allison Harris), Yale University
2025 Teaching Fellow, *Politics of Expertise* (Prof. Federico Brandmayr), Yale University
2024 Teaching Fellow, *Contesting Injustice* (Prof. Elisabeth Jean Wood), Yale University
2023 Teaching Fellow, *State, Conflict and Political Order* (Profs. Emily Sellars and Daniel Hirschel-Burns), Yale University
Teaching Fellow, *The Rise of China* (Prof. Daniel Mattingly), Yale University
2021–2024 Graduate Writing Fellow, Poorvu Center for Teaching and Learning, Yale University
2018–2020 Research Coordinator, World Bank
2014–2016 Research Associate, Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab (J-PAL) South Asia

ACADEMIC SERVICE

- 2024 Reviewer, *American Political Science Review*
2022 Graduate Student Coordinator, Political Violence Workshop
2021–2022 Graduate Student Coordinator, South Asia Brown Bag Series
Research assistance for Tom Ginsburg, Egor Lazarev, and Rachel Brulé

FIELD AND ARCHIVAL RESEARCH

International: United Kingdom (2022), Kenya (2019), Philippines (2018)
India: Delhi and Mumbai (2025), Pondicherry (2016), Rajasthan (2015), Uttar Pradesh (2014)

SKILLS AND TRAINING

- Tools R (advanced), Python (intermediate), SQL (basic)
Languages English (fluent), Hindi (conversational), Kannada (native)
Training Institute for Qualitative and Multi-Method Research (IQMR), June 2023